

Grade 7 Accelerated Mathematics

Course Syllabus · 2026–2027 · Windy Hill Middle School

Mr. Shaffer · [school email]

About this course

Grade 7 Accelerated Mathematics (course 1205050) is an accelerated course. It covers all of the Grade 8 math standards in Florida's B.E.S.T. Standards, plus several Grade 7 standards, so that students are ready for Algebra 1 in 8th grade. Florida's course description names six areas of emphasis:

- Scientific notation, and extending numbers to the real number system, including irrational numbers
- Equivalent numeric and algebraic expressions, including the Laws of Exponents
- Linear relationships, including modeling data with a linear equation
- Solving linear equations, inequalities and systems of linear equations
- The concept of a function
- Two-dimensional figures, especially triangles, using distance, angles and the Pythagorean Theorem

Students take the Grade 8 FAST, Florida's statewide progress-monitoring test, three times this year: fall, winter and spring.

Materials

- **Math Nation** — our textbook and online platform, with instructional videos
- **IXL** — online practice assigned after each lesson
- **Lessons and practice sets** I create for this course, aligned to the B.E.S.T. standards
- **A notebook for class notes, and pencils**

How grades work

These are graded in every unit:

- **Unit tests.** Each unit ends with a test given over two class periods (two short units sometimes share one test). A Unit Review goes home before each test for practice.
- **Vocabulary quizzes.**
- **Notebook checks.**
- **IXL.** Assigned after each lesson and due at the start of the next class. An assignment is complete when every listed skill reaches a SmartScore of 67 (IXL's measure of mastery, out of 100). When two lessons in a row use the same skills, they count as one assignment, due after the second lesson.

Other classwork may also be graded from time to time. Grades are posted in Focus, where you can check your child's progress at any time.

Grades follow Florida's grading scale for grades 6–12:

A	B	C	D	F
90–100%	80–89%	70–79%	60–69%	0–59%

Late work, retakes and absences

Late work and test retakes follow Lake County Schools' grading policy. I handle them individually, so if your child has late or missing work, or would like to talk about a test, please reach out.

After an absence, your child should check with me about missed work. Math Nation's videos are a good way to catch up on a lesson.

The year at a glance

The order of units is set; the timing is approximate and may shift to meet students' needs. Test dates are announced in class.

When (approx.)	Unit	What students learn
Aug – Sep	Units 1–2: Equations and Inequalities; Real Numbers, Square Roots and Cube Roots	Two-step equations and inequalities; rewriting rational numbers; squares, cubes and roots; rational and irrational numbers
Late Sep – mid Oct	Unit 3: Exponents and Scientific Notation	Laws of exponents; very large and very small numbers in scientific notation
Late Oct	Unit 4: Solving Problems with Rational Numbers	Operations in scientific notation; significant digits; order of operations with exponents and roots
Late Oct – early Nov	Unit 5: Multi-Step Problems with Proportional Relationships	Scale drawings; converting units between measurement systems
November	Unit 6: Relationships in Triangles	The Pythagorean Theorem and its converse; distance on the coordinate plane; similar triangles
Early Dec	Unit 7: Representing Proportional Relationships	Tables, graphs and equations; the constant of proportionality
Mid Dec	Winter FAST (PM2) review	Review days before the winter progress-monitoring test
Mid Dec – early Jan	Unit 8: Relationships in Circles	Circumference and area of circles; circle graphs
Mid Jan	Unit 9: Surface Area and Volume	Surface area and volume of cylinders
Late Jan – early Feb	Unit 10: Linear Relationships	Slope, y-intercept and graphs of lines
February	Unit 11: Solving Equations and Systems of Equations	Multi-step equations; systems of two linear equations
Late Feb – early Mar	Unit 12: Functions	What a function is; linear and nonlinear functions; reading graphs
March	Unit 13: Representing Data	Scatter plots and lines of fit; choosing a display for data
Early Apr	Unit 14: Equivalent Algebraic Expressions	Laws of exponents with variables; multiplying and factoring expressions
Mid Apr	Unit 15: Transformations	Translations, reflections, rotations and dilations
Late Apr	Unit 16: Properties and Theorems of Angles	Angle relationships; angles of triangles and polygons
Late Apr	Unit 17: Probability	Probability of single and repeated experiments; making predictions
May	Spring FAST (PM3)	Review before the test, then a preview of Algebra 1

Staying in touch

- **Email:** [\[school email\]](#)
- **Grades:** the Focus parent portal
- I'm happy to set up a phone call or a meeting.

I'm looking forward to a great year. — Mr. Shaffer